Cover Letter Development

What is a cover letter?

A cover letter is a **one-page formal letter** that introduces you to an employer. It is a **marketing tool** that highlights your **specific accomplishments, provides contex**t for your achievements, and **explains your interest** in joining the company.

Cover letters **should always be individually tailored to roles**. A compelling cover letter answers "**Why you?" and "Why them?"**

Paragraph 1:

Why them? Make a connection!

- Position applying for
- Referencing contacts/referrals
- News story or recent company accolades
- Reason you are applying to this company
- Provide a brief and compelling message as to why this company.
    - Use formal and confident language. *Statements such as "I think I am a great fit" or "I love this type of work" are not appropriate*

Paragraphs 2-3:

Why you? Sell your value.

- What skills or qualities is the application looking for?
    - Evaluate your background and choose 2-3 of the listed skills/qualities
    - Provide specific examples by using persuasive language to bridge your experience and what the application is looking for
        - Anyone can say they are a dedicated hard worker with excellent communication skills—minimize the usage of buzzwords.
- Explain how your qualifications and previous experiences will benefit the employer.

Paragraph 4:

Provide gratitude and a call to action.

- Thank them for their time and consideration.
- You want the employer to contact you to learn more about you "*I'm looking forward to speaking with you further," "I look forward to discussing my qualifications in detail*"

Same heading from resume
Same contact information from resume

March 4th, 2024

Current date

Super Frog
Texas Christian University Mascot
2800 S University Dr
Fort Worth, TX 76109

Address to the hiring manager, if possible. Include company name and address

Dear Mr. Super Frog:

If you are unsure who to address it to, include the company name and address and use "Dear Hiring Committee":

Texas Christian University's recent completion of the Lead On campaign attests to its commitment to innovation and developing leaders inside and outside the classroom. Isabella Anzaldua, who works in the BNSF Center for Career and Professional Development Center, informed me about the Marketing Coordinator position and encouraged me to apply.

As a current intern with ABC Marketing, I am charged with managing one client's social media handles and developing weekly content. Understanding the client's unique brand voice and vision is integral to social media management, and I've conducted in-depth trend research and client meetings to develop appealing social media content and maximize analytics outcomes. As a result, my client's Instagram audience engagement has grown by 120% during my position tenure.

Further, my previous internship with TCU Athletics provided me with the opportunity to strengthen the notable TCU Big-12 athletic program's name and image through strategic campaign development. I partnered with four interns and three directors to strategize unique ways to reach fans during games. After researching various initiatives, our team developed a comprehensive strategy to market TCU Athletics during in-game promotions, reaching audiences of up to ~45,000 during football games.

Thank you for your time in considering me for this opportunity and I look forward to visiting with you about this position in greater detail. Should you need further information, please do not hesitate to contact me by phone or email.

Sincerely,

Your Name

Paragraph 1: Hook, why them? Name drop, if possible

Paragraphs 2-3: Why you? Provide specific examples to back up your statements. Quantify and be strategic

Paragraph 4: Closing, call to action. What are you next steps?

ANATOMY OF A COVER LETTER

Use the same heading from your resume on your cover letter

Date

Contact Person's First and Last Name, Title
Organization or Company Name
Address Line 1
City, State Zip Code

Header (optional)

Dear Mr./Ms. Last Name:

Greeting

First Paragraph

Why are you writing? Begin by stating where or how you found out about the job. If you have had a prior conversation with someone in the organization who requested your resume, refer to the person's full name and that you are following up from that conversation. If you have been referred by someone, include that person's name. Mention your specific interest in the position and organization. Be clear and concise.

Middle Paragraph

What do you have to offer? (1-2 concise paragraphs) You are interpreting your resume in this paragraph—do not just repeat what is on the resume. Get to the point by highlighting 1-2 relevant skills and quantifiable accomplishments. Make connections between your abilities and the employer's needs based on what you have researched about the position, company and industry. Support each statement with evidence or quantifiable result that demonstrates your fit and passion. Convince the reader that they should grant you an interview based on what you can do. This may be the longest paragraph, but never more than 10-12 lines of text.

Final Paragraph

What is your call to action or next step? Refer to it in this paragraph. Demonstrate professional courtesy by thanking the reader for reviewing your credentials. End with no more than 2-4 lines of text.

Sincerely,

<Signature>

Your typed name here

Closing

QUICK TIPS



Research and demonstrate your knowledge of the organization in the context of why you are qualified.



Interpret your resume. Communicate how you can contribute to the organization in this role.



Proofread! Proofread! Proofread! Spelling errors and bad grammar or syntax leave a negative impression.